Research Proposal: Assignment Brief

Foundations of Clinical Research · Level 1: From Clinical Question to Publication

Organisation: Neudata (*#ClearDataClearImpact*)

Who: every participant, on their own. There are no groups.

What: a research proposal with a publication plan (about 6 to 8 pages) and 6 slides

Deadline: before 19:30 on Saturday 19 December 2026 (Session 8), by email to myluong1710@gmail.com

1. The task

Choose one question from your own department and plan a study to answer it: a clear question, a suitable design, good data, attention to bias and ethics, a realistic timeline and a plan to publish. You do not collect or analyse any data.

A good topic is a problem you see often, that matters to patients, and that your department could study in 12 to 24 months. In class we use one running example (fluids in septic shock). Please choose a different topic.

The proposal is the first of your two individual products. The second is described in the manuscript brief shared in Session 6.

2. Four parts, built in class

You write the proposal in the proposal template, sent by email with this brief: `Research_Proposal_Template.docx` (English) and `Research_Proposal_Template_VN.docx` (Vietnamese). Each heading has short guidance and a worked example.

In the proposal builder at the end of each session, the instructor fills in one part for the running example on the shared screen. You then write the same part for your own question at home, before the next session.

Part	What you write	Built in session	Finish before session
Part 1: Ask	Topic, PICO, research question, FINER check, aim, objectives, hypothesis	1	2
Part 1: Ask	PubMed search, 5 key references, problem statement, working title	2	3
Part 2: Design	Design and justification, setting, population	3	4
Part 2: Design	Exposure and comparator, outcomes, main biases and how you reduce them	4	5
Part 3: Measure	Variables table, mini-CRF, data dictionary, data management	5	6
Part 3: Measure	Sample size, analysis plan, missing-data plan	6	7
Part 4: Protect and publish	Ethics and consent, registration, confidentiality, feasibility, publication plan (journal, reporting guideline, authors, title, abstract skeleton)	7	8

Questions are welcome in the chat during the proposal builder, or by email to the course lead between sessions.

3. The presentation

- **Everyone** prepares 6 slides from their proposal. `Presentation_Guide.pdf`, sent by email with this brief, gives the content of each slide, tips and the feedback format.
- **About 5 volunteers** present in Session 8: 6 minutes, then 2 minutes of feedback from the class and the instructor.
- **To volunteer**, email the course lead by Wednesday 16 December. Presenting is voluntary.

4. Submission

What	The proposal (Word, from the template) and your 6 slides (PowerPoint or PDF). Everyone sends both.
When	Before 19:30 on Saturday 19 December 2026 (Session 8)
How	By email to the course lead, Vương Mỹ Lượng: myluong1710@gmail.com
File names	Surname_Firstname_Proposal.docx and Surname_Firstname_slides.pptx (or .pdf), e.g. Nguyen_An_Proposal.docx and Nguyen_An_slides.pptx
Language	English. If English is impossible for you, write in Vietnamese.
Cover page	Your name, profession and working title

- **Patient data:** no real patient data, names or record numbers. Give unit figures as approximate numbers (e.g. "about 40 admissions with septic shock per year").
- **Your own work:** write in your own words and cite every source.
- **AI tools:** you may use them for language or ideas. Say so in one line at the end ("AI use: ..."), check every fact and reference yourself, and never let AI invent a reference.

5.

The instructors score every proposal with `Proposal_Rubric.pdf`, sent by email with this brief.

Who	What is scored	Points
Everyone	The written proposal: 11 criteria, from problem statement to publication plan	70
Presenters only	The presentation: structure, clarity, visual design, timekeeping, answers to questions	30

Presenters are scored out of 100 (70 + 30). For everyone else the written score is scaled to 100, so not presenting does not lower the score. You receive written comments within about 3 weeks. Presenters also receive their feedback form and the class comments by email after Session 8. You may send a revised proposal within 2 weeks of Session 8 for a second round of comments.